PRIN 2026: funded projects

Data of 2026-10-11; 18 of 28 sectors

1 Scope

The report covers 18 of the 28 ERC sectors of the PRIN 2026 call, those for which the MUR had published the decree, the ranking (Tabella A) and the funded projects (Tabella B) when the data were extracted: LS2, LS3, LS4, LS7, PE1, PE2, PE3, PE5, PE6, PE7, PE8, PE9, PE10, PE11, SH4, SH5, SH6 and SH7. Not yet published: PE4, LS1, LS5, LS6, LS8, LS9, SH1, SH2, SH3 and SH8. Every figure and number refers to these 18 sectors only.

1.1 Definitions

- **Budget**: the sum, over the 18 sectors, of the funds that the decrees make available to each sector (under-40 pool plus ordinary pool): 164.01 M EUR.
- **Share**: MUR contribution received by an institution, region or other group, divided by the budget, in percent.
- **PI** and **RU**: the coordinating unit of a project and its partner units; the money of a project is the sum of the MUR contributions of its units.
- **Under-40 PI**: a principal investigator printed in green in the MUR tables.

1.2 Data

144 funded projects and 726 funded units (144 PI, 582 RU) from Tabella B, receiving 155.40 M EUR (94.75% of the budget). Tabella A lists 235 ranked projects, 144 of them funded; it contains the projects the evaluation committees judged fundable, not all the projects submitted. Gender is inferred from the first given name with a table of 287 names (60 assigned by hand, 227 by the Italian ending rule); it is a binary inference used only in aggregate. City, region and type of each institution come from a hand-checked table of 84 institutions; regional boundaries are simplified ISTAT shapes. Resident population by region (1 January 2026) and professors, researchers and research fellows of the universities by region (2024, from the MUR statistical office open data) are in `data/`; their sources are given in the README.

2 Analyses

2.1 Budget and funded money per sector

Purpose. To compare, sector by sector, the money funded with the budget the decrees make available, and to separate the money that went to projects whose PI is under 40.

Result. The budget is 164.01 M EUR and 155.40 M EUR (94.8%) was funded. Per sector, the funded money is between 82.5% of the budget of LS3 and 100.0% of the budget of PE1. 37 of

the 144 funded projects have an under-40 PI; they received 40.11 M EUR (25.8% of the funded money). The under-40 pools of the 18 sectors add up to 24.32 M EUR; in 13 sectors the money of the under-40 PIs' projects is larger than the sector's pool. 9 funded under-40 projects rank below the best unfunded project of an over-40 PI (LS4, LS7, PE1, PE5, PE8, SH5 and SH6).

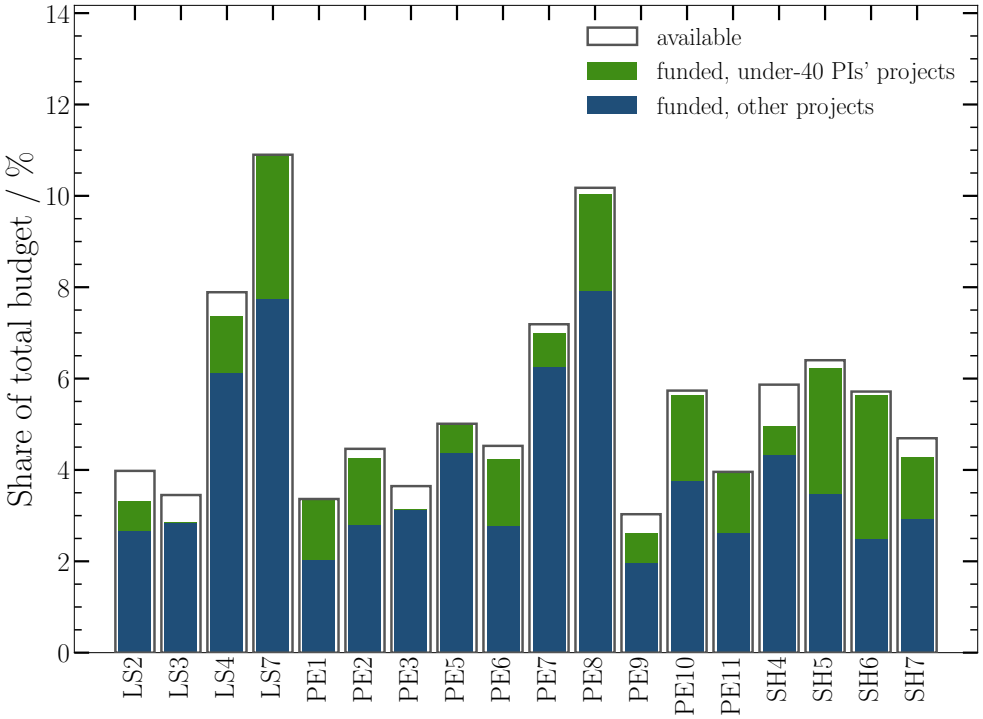


Figure 1: Per sector, in percent of the total budget: budget available (outline) and funded money, split into projects of under-40 PIs (green) and the others (blue). 18 of 28 sectors.

2.2 Funding by institution

Purpose. To show which institutions received the largest shares of the budget and how the budget is divided among institutions.

Result. 84 institutions have at least one funded unit. The largest share is that of CNR (7.2%), followed by Sapienza (6.2%) and Padova (4.6%). The 10 best-funded institutions received 41.0% of the budget and the 20 best-funded 61.0%; after accounting for them, 59.0% and 39.0% of the budget are left.

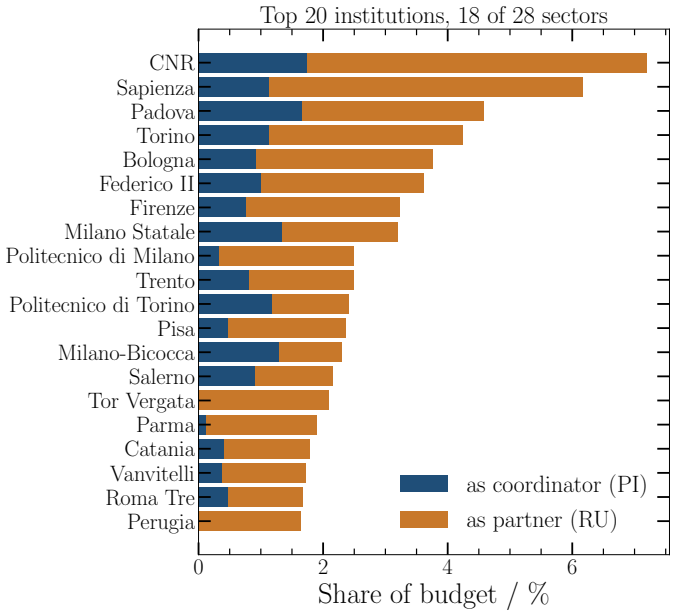


Figure 2: Share of the total budget of the 20 best-funded institutions, as coordinator (PI) and as partner (RU).

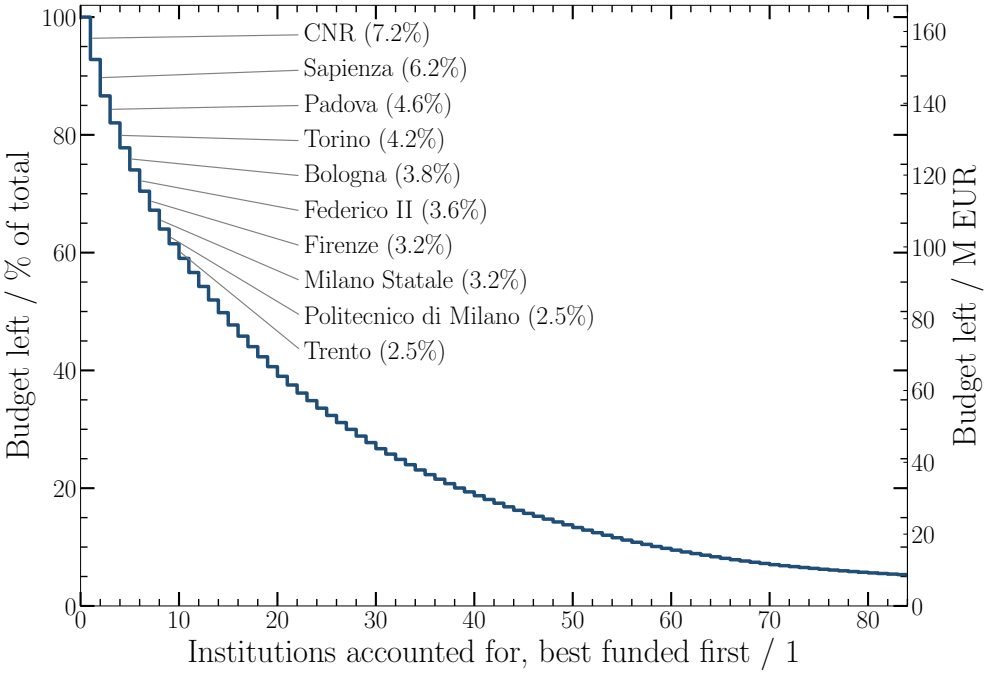


Figure 3: Budget left, in percent of the total, as the institutions are accounted for from the best funded to the least funded; the ten largest steps are named.

2.3 Institution types

Purpose. To show how the budget is divided among types of institution (public and private universities, telematic universities, advanced schools, research bodies).

Result. Public universities received 76.9% of the budget, national research bodies 9.4%, private universities 3.9%, advanced schools 2.7%, telematic universities 1.3%. The table gives the number of institutions and the shares by role.

Type	Institutions	Projects	Share (%)	as PI (%)	as RU (%)
Public univ.	58	144	76.88	20.11	56.77
Private univ.	8	28	3.87	0.73	3.14
Telematic univ.	4	12	1.32	0.00	1.32
Advanced schools	7	15	2.71	1.34	1.37
Research bodies	2	4	0.50	0.00	0.50
National bodies	4	58	9.36	2.07	7.29
AFAM	1	1	0.10	0.00	0.10

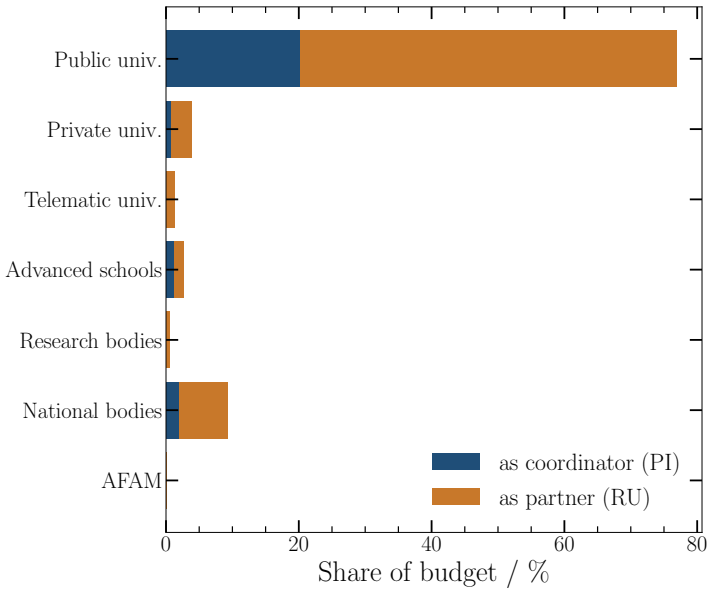


Figure 4: Share of the total budget by institution type, as coordinator (PI) and as partner (RU).

2.4 MUR contribution per unit

Purpose. To show the distribution of the money assigned to a single unit, for coordinating and for partner units.

Result. The 144 coordinating units received a median of 258 k EUR (quartiles 222 and 303; range 150 to 618 k EUR). The 582 partner units received a median of 193 k EUR (quartiles 167 and 222; range 56 to 489 k EUR).

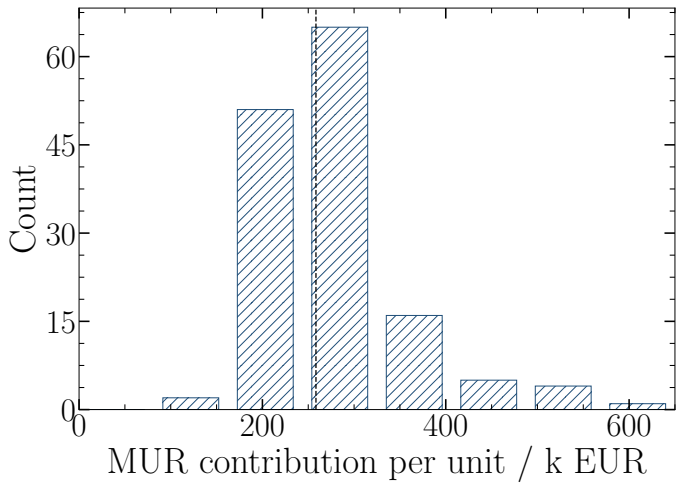


Figure 5: Histogram of the MUR contribution of the coordinating units; the dashed line is the median.

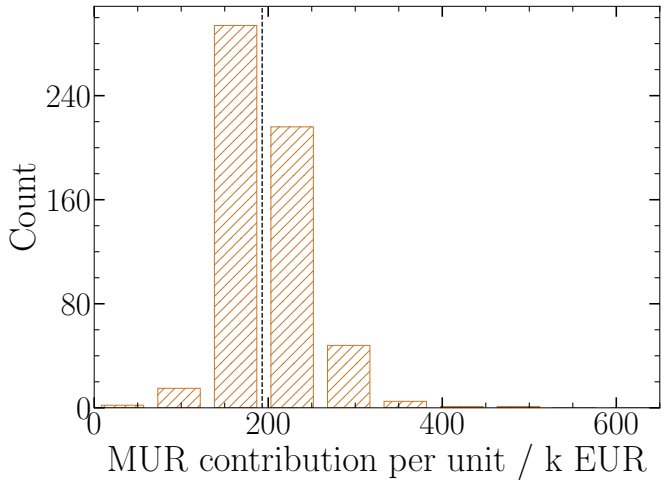


Figure 6: Histogram of the MUR contribution of the partner units; the dashed line is the median.

2.5 Geography

Purpose. To show where the money went: by region, by city, and, per region and macro-area, which part of the funding came from units coordinating projects and which from partner units.

Result. The regions with the largest shares are Lombardia (14.4%), Lazio (12.9%) and Campania (8.9%). National research bodies (CNR, INAF, INFN, INGV), which have no region, received 9.4%. No funded unit is in Valle d'Aosta. The 53 cities with a funded unit include Roma (11.8%), Milano (10.3%), Torino (6.9%), Napoli (4.9%) and Padova (4.6%) as the five largest. The share of the money received by units coordinating projects is, by macro-area: North 30%; Centre 21%; South and Islands 24%. Liguria, Molise, Basilicata and Calabria have no coordinating unit among their funded units. The table of regions is in Appendix C.

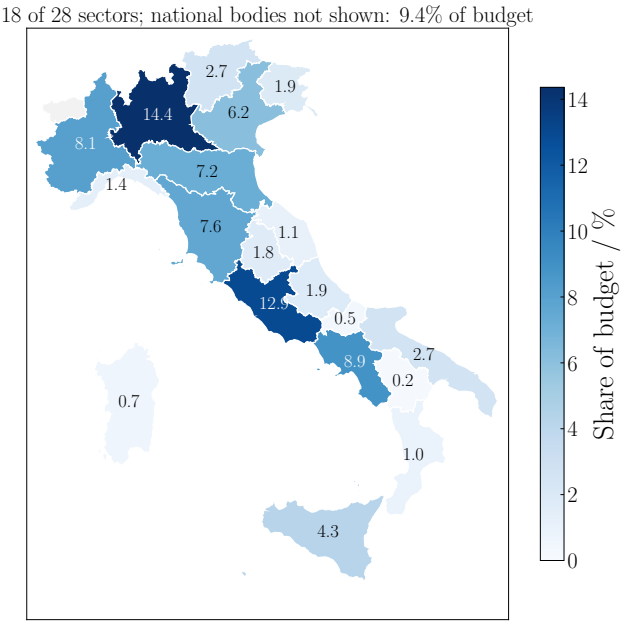


Figure 7: Share of the total budget by region; national research bodies are not shown.

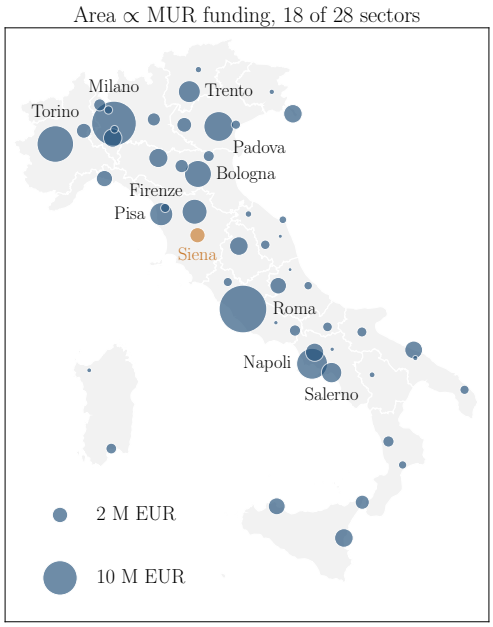


Figure 8: MUR funding by city (circle area proportional to the money).

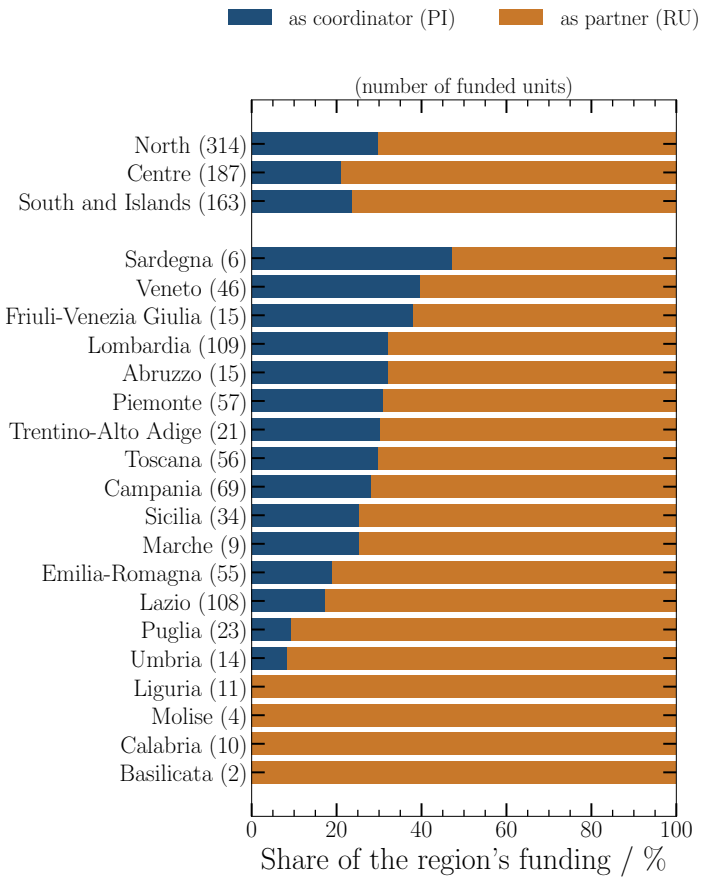


Figure 9: Share of each macro-area's and region's funding received as coordinating (PI) and as partner (RU) units; in brackets, the number of funded units.

2.6 Collaboration between cities

Purpose. To show which cities share funded projects, counting the national research bodies as one node.

Result. 511 pairs of nodes share at least one funded project and 28 share eight or more. The pairs sharing the most projects are national bodies–Roma (28), Milano–Roma (27), national bodies–Torino (25), Milano–national bodies (24) and Milano–Torino (23).

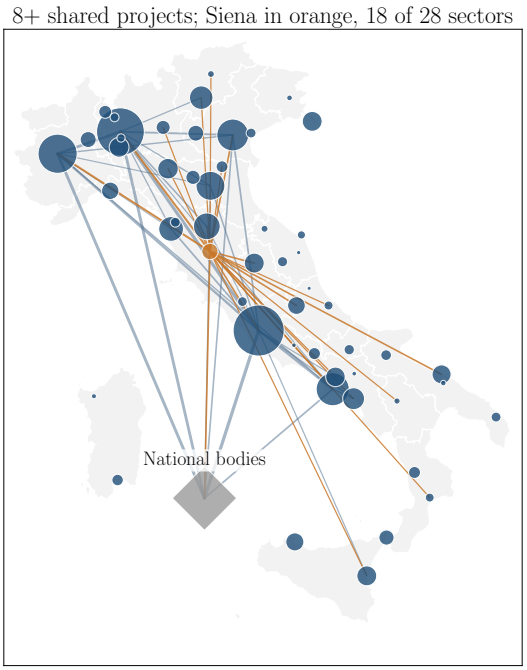


Figure 10: Pairs of cities sharing at least 8 funded projects (line width proportional to the number); circle area proportional to the money; the diamond is the national research bodies. 18 of 28 sectors.

2.7 Breadth across sectors

Purpose. To show in how many sectors each institution has funded units, against the share of the budget it received.

Result. The number of sectors with at least one funded unit has median 3 across the 84 institutions; 19 institutions have funded units in one sector only. The maximum, 16 sectors, is reached by Padova. The Spearman correlation between the number of sectors and the money received is 0.94 ($p = 4e\text{-}39$).

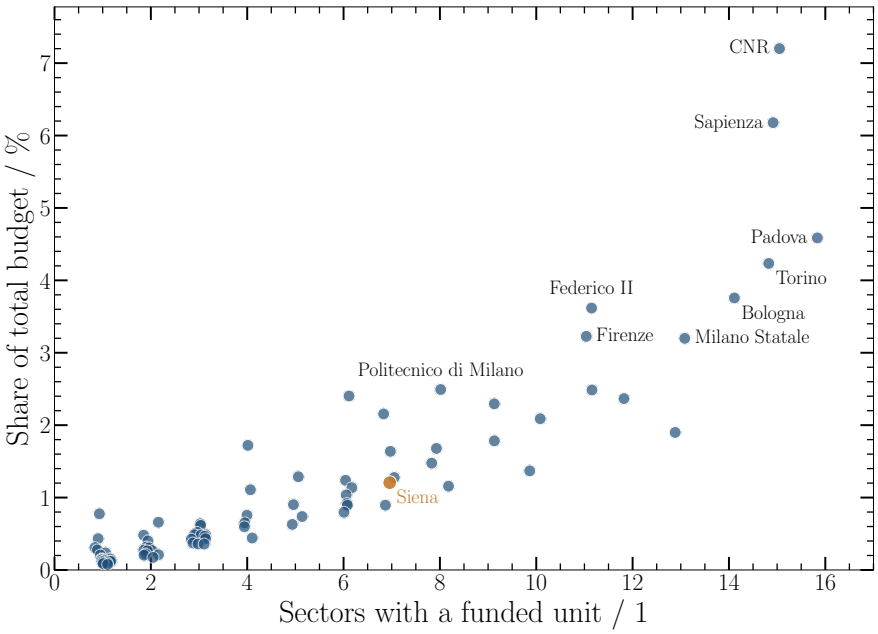


Figure 11: Share of the total budget of each institution against the number of sectors with a funded unit (horizontal jitter added).

2.8 Gender of the unit leaders

Purpose. To show the share of women among the leaders of the funded units, with the uncertainty due to the small numbers, by macro-area (PE, LS, SH).

Result. Among the 144 funded PIs, 33% are women (95% interval 26–41); among the 582 leaders of funded partner units, 37% (33–41). The first given name was found in the name table for all 726 leaders considered. The table gives the shares by macro-area.

Group	Area	Leaders	Women (%)	95% interval
PI, funded	PE	74	28	19–40
PI, funded	LS	38	37	23–53
PI, funded	SH	32	41	26–58
PI, funded	All	144	33	26–41
Partner-unit leaders, funded	PE	305	25	21–30
Partner-unit leaders, funded	LS	153	50	42–58
Partner-unit leaders, funded	SH	124	48	39–56
Partner-unit leaders, funded	All	582	37	33–41

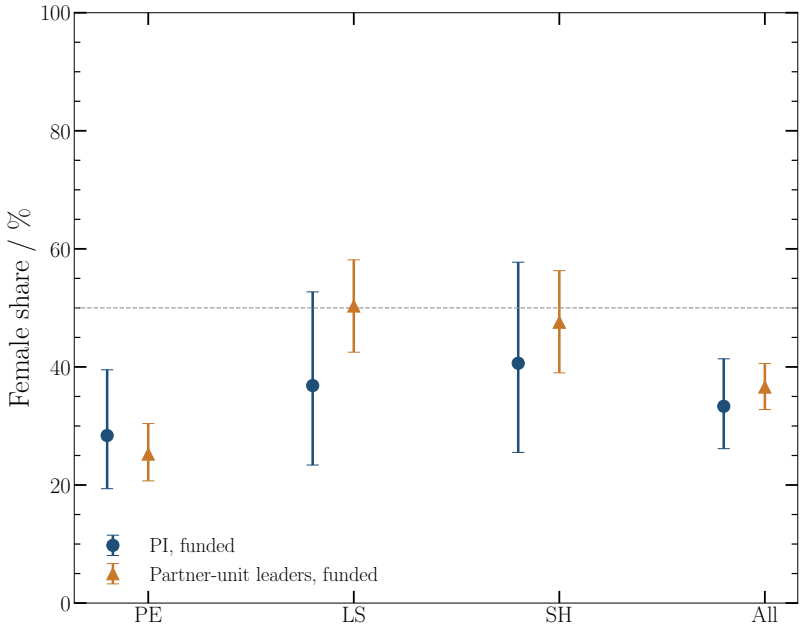


Figure 12: Share of women among the leaders of the funded units, with Wilson 95% intervals; the dashed line marks 50%.

2.9 Budget, population and university staff by region

Purpose. To compare the share of the budget of each region with its share of the resident population and of the professors and researchers of its universities.

Result. Across the 19 regions with funded units, the share of the budget has Pearson correlation 0.91 and Spearman correlation 0.83 with the share of the resident population, and 0.96 and 0.88 with the share of professors and researchers (national research bodies excluded; Valle d'Aosta has no funded unit and is left out). The table gives the shares and, in the last two columns, the share of the budget divided by the share of the population and of the staff.

Region	Population (%)	Staff (%)	Budget (%)	Budget/population	Budget/staff
Trentino-Alto Adige	1.9	1.8	3.2	1.71	1.79
Piemonte	7.2	6.4	9.4	1.31	1.47
Umbria	1.4	1.6	2.1	1.45	1.33
Lazio	9.7	12.5	15.2	1.56	1.21
Toscana	6.2	7.5	8.9	1.44	1.20
Molise	0.5	0.5	0.6	1.16	1.18
Veneto	8.2	6.8	7.2	0.88	1.06
Campania	9.4	9.9	10.4	1.10	1.05
Lombardia	17.1	16.6	16.8	0.99	1.02
Friuli-Venezia Giulia	2.0	2.3	2.2	1.11	0.96
Emilia-Romagna	7.6	9.5	8.4	1.11	0.89
Abruzzo	2.1	2.7	2.2	1.01	0.81
Sicilia	8.1	6.9	5.0	0.62	0.72
Liguria	2.6	2.2	1.6	0.62	0.72
Puglia	6.6	4.8	3.2	0.49	0.67
Calabria	3.1	2.2	1.2	0.38	0.54
Marche	2.5	2.6	1.3	0.50	0.49
Basilicata	0.9	0.5	0.2	0.23	0.42
Sardegna	2.6	2.7	0.8	0.32	0.31
Valle d'Aosta	0.2	0.1	0.0	0.00	0.00

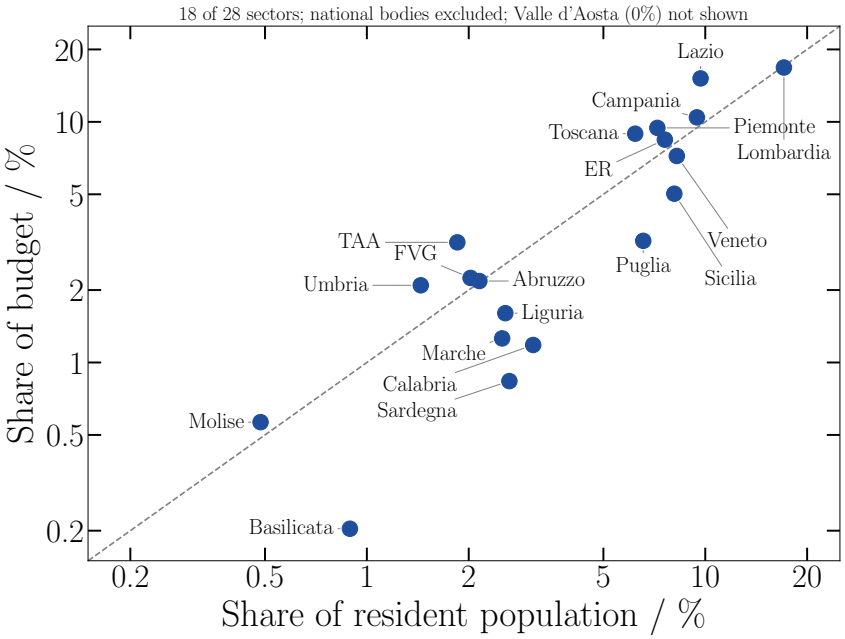


Figure 13: Share of the budget of each region against its share of the resident population (1 January 2026); logarithmic axes, the dashed line marks equal shares. ER: Emilia-Romagna; FVG: Friuli-Venezia Giulia; TAA: Trentino-Alto Adige.

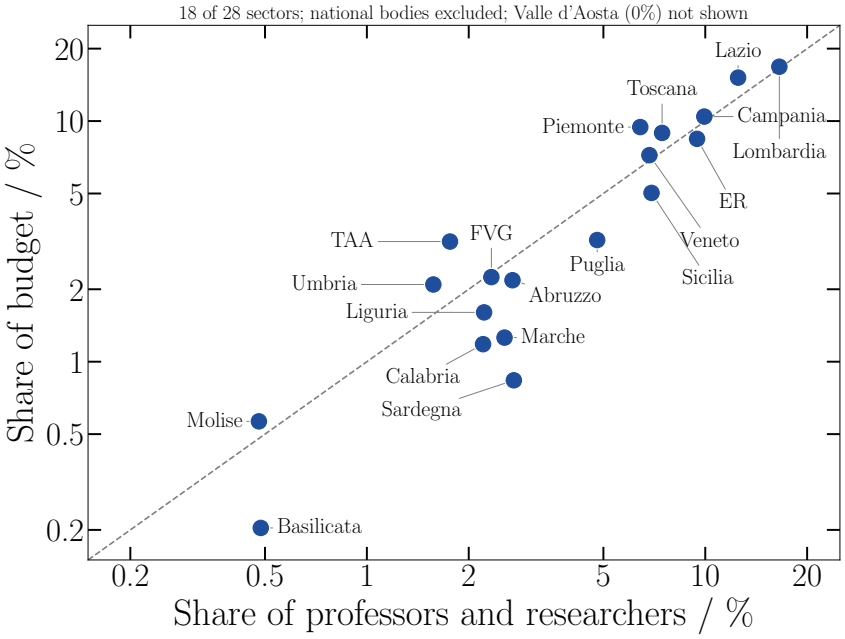


Figure 14: As above, against the share of professors and researchers of the universities of the region (2024).

2.10 Institution fact sheet: Siena

Purpose. To collect the figures of one institution and compare them with the other institutions of the same type.

Result. Siena received 1.98 M EUR (1.21% of the budget) in 8 projects, 5 as coordinator and 3 as partner, in 7 sectors; it ranks 26 of 84 institutions and 24 of 58 within its type.

Siena	Value	Median, public univ.
Funding	1.98 M EUR, 1.21% of the budget	0.89%
Rank	26 of 84; 24 of 58 in its type	
Funded projects	8	7
Sectors with a funded unit	7 of 18	6
Money received as PI	74%	19%

Sector	Role	k EUR	Project	Coordinator	Other institutions
LS4	RU	164	Addressing the immunometabolic landscape fueling...	Milano Statale	Bari Aldo Moro, Cattolica, Magna Graecia, Vanvitelli
LS7	PI	378	Integrative Tumor and cfDNA Methylation Analysis to Predict...	this institution	Bari Aldo Moro, Federico II, Torino
LS7	PI	255	ENDOCARE: CB2 receptor targeting in endometriosis —...	this institution	Chieti-Pescara, L'Aquila, Parma, UniCamillus
PE5	RU	173	TWIST — ToWard chiral light from Inverted Singlet-Triplet...	Padova	Basilicata, Bolzano, Brescia, Torino
PE7	RU	175	Modular Surfaces with AI-driven Conversion for Integrated...	Firenze	CNR, Catania, Perugia, Politecnico di Milano
SH4	PI	249	Accent Representation, Ideologies, and Attitudes (ARIA)	this institution	CNR, Salerno, Sapienza, Tor Vergata
SH5	PI	387	DAPHNE – Digital Archive of Petrarchan Heritage and...	this institution	Cattolica, Ferrara, Pegaso, Perugia
SH6	PI	197	AFTER: Afterlives of fascism in everyday spaces	this institution	L'Aquila, Padova, Torino, Trento

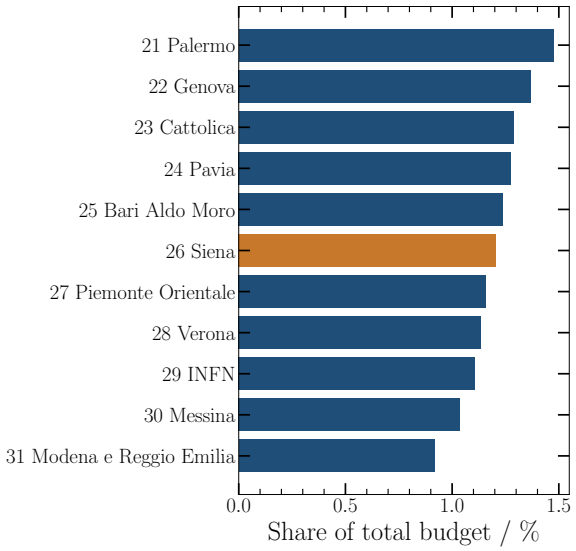


Figure 15: Share of the total budget of Siena and of the institutions ranked just above and below it.



Figure 16: Cities sharing funded projects with Siena (line width proportional to the number of projects).

A Decrees

Sector	Decree n.	Date	MUR page
LS2	37	06/10/2026	page
LS3	38	06/10/2026	page
LS4	42	06/10/2026	page
LS7	39	06/10/2026	page
PE1	29	05/10/2026	page
PE2	30	05/10/2026	page
PE3	31	05/10/2026	page
PE5	47	08/10/2026	page
PE6	48	08/10/2026	page
PE7	45	06/10/2026	page
PE8	33	05/10/2026	page
PE9	34	05/10/2026	page
PE10	35	05/10/2026	page
PE11	36	05/10/2026	page
SH4	40	06/10/2026	page
SH5	41	06/10/2026	page
SH6	44	06/10/2026	page
SH7	49	09/10/2026	page

B Sectors

Sector	Available	Funded	Funded (%)	Projects	Ranked	Under-40 pool	Under-40 PIs' projects
LS2	6.53 M EUR	5.43 M EUR	83.2	5	8	0.91 M EUR	1.05 M EUR
LS3	5.66 M EUR	4.67 M EUR	82.5	4	7	0.78 M EUR	0.00 M EUR
LS4	12.94 M EUR	12.09 M EUR	93.4	12	16	1.85 M EUR	2.05 M EUR
LS7	17.88 M EUR	17.88 M EUR	100.0	17	28	3.06 M EUR	5.17 M EUR
PE1	5.52 M EUR	5.52 M EUR	100.0	5	8	1.04 M EUR	2.16 M EUR
PE2	7.32 M EUR	6.99 M EUR	95.6	6	12	1.20 M EUR	2.40 M EUR
PE3	5.98 M EUR	5.14 M EUR	86.0	5	8	0.84 M EUR	0.00 M EUR
PE5	8.22 M EUR	8.22 M EUR	100.0	8	12	1.03 M EUR	1.03 M EUR
PE6	7.42 M EUR	6.95 M EUR	93.5	6	11	1.33 M EUR	2.40 M EUR
PE7	11.79 M EUR	11.45 M EUR	97.1	11	18	1.54 M EUR	1.20 M EUR
PE8	16.69 M EUR	16.46 M EUR	98.6	14	22	2.57 M EUR	3.48 M EUR
PE9	4.97 M EUR	4.29 M EUR	86.4	4	8	0.68 M EUR	1.06 M EUR
PE10	9.41 M EUR	9.24 M EUR	98.2	9	14	1.20 M EUR	3.08 M EUR
PE11	6.49 M EUR	6.49 M EUR	100.0	6	10	1.05 M EUR	2.17 M EUR
SH4	9.62 M EUR	8.12 M EUR	84.4	8	16	1.50 M EUR	1.02 M EUR
SH5	10.50 M EUR	10.22 M EUR	97.3	9	16	1.47 M EUR	4.50 M EUR
SH6	9.37 M EUR	9.25 M EUR	98.6	9	14	1.16 M EUR	5.14 M EUR
SH7	7.70 M EUR	7.00 M EUR	91.0	6	7	1.11 M EUR	2.21 M EUR

C Regions

Region	Share (%)	Projects	PI units	RU units	As PI (%)
Piemonte	8.06	54	14	43	31
Valle d'Aosta	0.00	0	0	0	
Liguria	1.37	11	0	11	0
Lombardia	14.36	81	27	82	32
Trentino-Alto Adige	2.70	21	5	16	30
Veneto	6.16	45	15	31	40
Friuli-Venezia Giulia	1.92	14	5	10	38
Emilia-Romagna	7.20	48	8	47	19
Marche	1.08	9	2	7	25
Toscana	7.63	52	14	42	30
Umbria	1.79	13	1	13	8
Lazio	12.94	78	14	94	17
Campania	8.91	49	15	54	28
Abruzzo	1.86	14	4	11	32
Molise	0.48	4	0	4	0
Puglia	2.74	21	2	21	9
Basilicata	0.17	2	0	2	0
Calabria	1.01	10	0	10	0
Sicilia	4.29	30	7	27	25
Sardegna	0.71	6	2	4	47
National research bodies	9.36	58	9	53	22

D All institutions

Institutions with at least one funded unit, by funding (the region of each is in the institution table of the analysis output); share of the total budget, MUR contribution, projects, units as coordinator (PI) and partner (RU), sectors with a funded unit.

Rank	Institution	Type	City	Share (%)	k EUR	Proj.	PI	RU	Sect.
1	CNR	National bodies	Roma	7.20	11810	49	8	41	15
2	Sapienza	Public univ.	Roma	6.18	10131	50	7	43	15

Rank	Institution	Type	City	Share (%)	k EUR	Proj.	PI	RU	Sect.
3	Padova	Public univ.	Padova	4.59	7521	35	11	24	16
4	Torino	Public univ.	Torino	4.23	6943	31	6	25	15
5	Bologna	Public univ.	Bologna	3.76	6161	27	5	22	14
6	Federico II	Public univ.	Napoli	3.62	5933	29	7	22	11
7	Firenze	Public univ.	Firenze	3.23	5291	24	5	19	11
8	Milano Statale	Public univ.	Milano	3.20	5246	25	9	16	13
9	Politecnico di Milano	Public univ.	Milano	2.49	4088	19	2	17	8
10	Trento	Public univ.	Trento	2.49	4078	19	5	14	11
11	Politecnico di Torino	Public univ.	Torino	2.40	3941	16	7	9	6
12	Pisa	Public univ.	Pisa	2.37	3882	18	3	15	12
13	Milano-Bicocca	Public univ.	Milano	2.29	3762	16	8	8	9
14	Salerno	Public univ.	Salerno	2.16	3535	15	5	10	7
15	Tor Vergata	Public univ.	Roma	2.09	3425	18	0	18	10
16	Parma	Public univ.	Parma	1.90	3115	16	1	15	13
17	Catania	Public univ.	Catania	1.78	2925	15	3	12	9
18	Vanvitelli	Public univ.	Caserta	1.72	2823	13	2	11	4
19	Roma Tre	Public univ.	Roma	1.68	2753	13	3	10	8
20	Perugia	Public univ.	Perugia	1.64	2686	13	0	13	7
21	Palermo	Public univ.	Palermo	1.48	2419	11	3	8	8
22	Genova	Public univ.	Genova	1.37	2245	11	0	11	10
23	Cattolica	Private univ.	Milano	1.29	2112	10	1	9	5
24	Pavia	Public univ.	Pavia	1.28	2095	10	2	8	7
25	Bari Aldo Moro	Public univ.	Bari	1.24	2031	10	0	10	6
26	Siena	Public univ.	Siena	1.21	1978	8	5	3	7
27	Piemonte Orientale	Public univ.	Vercelli	1.16	1899	8	1	7	8
28	Verona	Public univ.	Verona	1.14	1864	7	4	3	6
29	INFN	National bodies	Roma	1.11	1817	6	0	6	4
30	Messina	Public univ.	Messina	1.04	1699	8	1	7	6
31	Modena e Reggio Emilia	Public univ.	Modena	0.92	1505	7	1	6	6
32	Vita-Salute San Raffaele	Private univ.	Milano	0.90	1480	6	2	4	5
33	Trieste	Public univ.	Trieste	0.90	1468	7	3	4	7
34	Brescia	Public univ.	Brescia	0.89	1466	8	0	8	6
35	L'Aquila	Public univ.	L'Aquila	0.80	1308	7	1	6	6
36	INAF	National bodies	Roma	0.78	1272	4	1	3	1
37	Insubria	Public univ.	Varese	0.76	1240	6	1	5	4
38	Parthenope	Public univ.	Napoli	0.74	1210	6	1	5	5
39	Cassino	Public univ.	Cassino	0.66	1081	6	2	4	2
40	Calabria	Public univ.	Rende	0.65	1068	6	0	6	4
41	SISSA	Advanced schools	Trieste	0.64	1049	5	2	3	3
42	Ferrara	Public univ.	Ferrara	0.63	1033	5	1	4	5
43	GSSI	Advanced schools	L'Aquila	0.62	1010	4	3	1	3
44	Cagliari	Public univ.	Cagliari	0.60	978	5	2	3	4
45	Foggia	Public univ.	Foggia	0.52	849	5	0	5	3
46	Unicusano	Telematic univ.	Roma	0.49	799	4	0	4	3
47	Link Campus University	Private univ.	Roma	0.49	798	5	0	5	3
48	Molise	Public univ.	Campobasso	0.48	791	4	0	4	3
49	IUSS Pavia	Advanced schools	Pavia	0.48	788	2	2	0	2
50	Camerino	Public univ.	Camerino	0.47	764	4	1	3	3
51	Salento	Public univ.	Lecce	0.44	724	4	1	3	4
52	IMT Lucca	Advanced schools	Lucca	0.43	710	3	0	3	1
53	Tuscia	Public univ.	Viterbo	0.43	706	3	2	1	3
54	Campus Bio-Medico	Private univ.	Roma	0.43	698	4	0	4	3
55	Politecnico di Bari	Public univ.	Bari	0.40	658	3	0	3	2
56	Chieti-Pescara	Public univ.	Chieti	0.37	610	3	0	3	3
57	Magna Graecia	Public univ.	Catanzaro	0.36	588	4	0	4	3
58	e-Campus	Telematic univ.	Novedrate	0.36	587	3	0	3	3
59	Ca' Foscari	Public univ.	Venezia	0.31	516	3	0	3	2
60	Humanitas University	Private univ.	Pieve Emanuele	0.31	507	3	0	3	1
61	Politecnica delle Marche	Public univ.	Ancona	0.30	500	2	1	1	2
62	INGV	National bodies	Roma	0.28	453	3	0	3	1
63	Pegaso	Telematic univ.	Napoli	0.27	450	3	0	3	2
64	INRiM	Research bodies	Torino	0.27	438	2	0	2	2
65	Sant'Anna	Advanced schools	Pisa	0.26	434	2	0	2	2

Rank	Institution	Type	City	Share (%)	k EUR	Proj.	PI	RU	Sect.
66	OGS	Research bodies	Trieste	0.24	388	2	0	2	1
67	Urbino	Public univ.	Urbino	0.22	360	2	0	2	2
68	Bolzano	Public univ.	Bolzano	0.21	344	2	0	2	2
69	UniCamillus	Private univ.	Roma	0.20	336	2	0	2	1
70	San Raffaele Roma	Telematic univ.	Roma	0.20	335	2	0	2	2
71	Basilicata	Public univ.	Potenza	0.17	285	2	0	2	2
72	L'Orientale	Public univ.	Napoli	0.16	257	1	0	1	1
73	Scuola Superiore Meridionale	Advanced schools	Napoli	0.15	250	1	0	1	1
74	Stranieri di Perugia	Public univ.	Perugia	0.15	245	1	1	0	1
75	Udine	Public univ.	Udine	0.15	241	1	0	1	1
76	LUM	Private univ.	Casamassima	0.14	224	1	1	0	1
77	Normale	Advanced schools	Pisa	0.13	211	1	1	0	1
78	IUAV	Public univ.	Venezia	0.12	205	1	0	1	1
79	Sassari	Public univ.	Sassari	0.12	194	1	0	1	1
80	IULM	Private univ.	Milano	0.12	189	1	0	1	1
81	Sannio	Public univ.	Benevento	0.10	163	1	0	1	1
82	Accademia Belle Arti Frosinone	AFAM	Frosinone	0.10	162	1	0	1	1
83	Macerata	Public univ.	Macerata	0.09	141	1	0	1	1
84	Teramo	Public univ.	Teramo	0.08	126	1	0	1	1